brutal acts. But rather they had sympathy for them, which was palpable in their denial to condemn them.

Chapter 6 describes the important stage of TTP-led terrorism from 2007 onwards when the suicide bombing peaked in various cities of Pakistan. Gun and grenade attacks and bomb blasts became common. All sort of targets, soft and hard, faced an unprecedented onslaught from terrorists. Markets were bombed, military installations were attacked, schools were targeted and several public places faced suicide attacks. It resulted in the deaths of more than 56,000 people until 2015.

Chapter 7 explores the state response to insurgency and terrorism. In 2002, the Pakistan Army resorted to counter insurgency against the terrorist groups in Waziristan and FATA; however, the focus was on Al Qaeda. The TTP had yet to be created. The first army operation against the TTP was launched against the Swati TTP in 2009. It was a success as the area was cleared of these elements. However, its main leaders including its chief Maulvi Fazlullah managed to escape. Shortly afterwards an operation was initiated against the TTP in South Waziristan. It continued until 2012 with mixed results. Many moved to North Waziristan and started operating from there. Despite the US pressure, the Pakistan Army was reluctant to open another front in a very treacherous terrain. As a result, the militants spread and carried out terrorism throughout Pakistan, which could not be controlled by the government. The disjointed, half-hearted and lackadaisical approach of Pakistan to counter these elements was evident from the fact that it could not control or annihilate the TTP although it was not great in number when compared to the Pakistan armed forces and security agencies. It was equipped with small arms and lived a medieval lifestyle in a remote corner of Pakistan, which is 1/20th of the size of the country, without access to air power or artillery. It lacked the numerical and military strength to defeat the Pakistani security forces in order to extend its writ to other areas of Pakistan outside their territories. Yet it operated persistently, engaging the army in an asymmetrical guerrilla war and became a real threat to the country.

Unfortunately, Pakistan did not formulate a national counter terrorism strategy. All provinces and departments acted in a disjointed and erratic manner, which was ineffective to control the outrageous situation. The role of security and intelligence agencies remained much below the par. Laws and courts were not prepared to handle terrorism cases. Above all, political will seemed absent. The army monopolised the